

Paragraph / section function - Workbook 1

Focused practice - Workbook 1 of 3

How to use this workbook

Read each text closely. Decide what relationship the question is testing before looking at the options. After checking the key, explain why the strongest wrong answer fails.

Before you start

- Use the surrounding text, not one isolated keyword.
- Prefer precise relationship words such as illustrates, qualifies, contrasts, supports, or results in.
- Do not accept an answer that merely summarizes when the question asks about function or effect.

Cooling Centers

The report opens by noting that three neighborhoods recorded more than twenty days above 38 C last summer. Many apartments in those areas lack central air-conditioning. The next paragraph explains that the city extended library hours and opened two recreation centers as evening cooling sites.

1. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. describes a response to a problem introduced earlier
- B. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- C. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

2. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It moves the report from describing heat risk to explaining what the city did about it.
- C. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- D. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.

Clinic Reminder

A clinic memo explains that missed appointments rose after the reminder system changed. One paragraph reproduces a typical reminder message: "Your visit is tomorrow at 2:30 p.m. Reply C to confirm." The memo then compares response rates for text and phone reminders.

3. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- B. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- C. provides a concrete example of the reminder being evaluated
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

4. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- C. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.
- D. The sample message lets readers see the exact communication discussed in the later comparison.

Old Clock

A short history describes the station clock as a meeting point for generations of travelers. The final paragraph explains that the clock no longer keeps accurate time but remains above the entrance after a restoration project.

5. What is the main function of this paragraph or section?

- A. shows how the clock's role has changed while its symbolic importance remains
- B. summarizes the entire passage without serving a specific local role
- C. introduces a new topic unrelated to the surrounding discussion
- D. gives background information that does not connect to the passage's main development

6. How does this part contribute to the larger text?

- A. It changes the topic rather than developing the writer's explanation.
- B. It concludes the history by connecting the object's present condition with its continuing significance.
- C. It repeats the previous sentence with no additional purpose.
- D. It gives information that conflicts with the surrounding paragraphs.

Answer key and reasoning

1. A. It moves the report from describing heat risk to explaining what the city did about it.
2. B. It moves the report from describing heat risk to explaining what the city did about it.
3. C. The sample message lets readers see the exact communication discussed in the later comparison.
4. D. The sample message lets readers see the exact communication discussed in the later comparison.
5. A. It concludes the history by connecting the object's present condition with its continuing significance.
6. B. It concludes the history by connecting the object's present condition with its continuing significance.

Mistake review

- If you summarized instead of explaining a relationship, label it summary-not-function.
- If you chose a transition or structure because of one keyword, label it one-clue trap.
- If you confused a quoted perspective with the author's own view, label it viewpoint source.
- If you named a rhetorical device but missed what it achieves, label it effect missed.
- Redo missed questions later without looking at the key.